

Date: January 8, 2025

REPORT OF FREE COMMUNITY MEDICAL OUTREACH, BY JOYFUL HEALTH FOUNDATION

INTRODUCTION

The year 2024 free community health Outreach organized by Joyful Health Foundation with its CEO Dr Philip Okeke and Co was successfully executed and completed at Ikperejere community.

The medical outreach was attended by team of professionals ranging from medical doctors, Optometrist, Medical laboratory Scientist and Nurses.

Ikperejere is a community located in Ihitte Uboma Local Government Area of Imo State Nigeria.

The free medical outreach accorded the residents of Ikperejere and nearby communities the opportunity to know their health status by providing them access to various multi-disease testing and counselling services as well as treatment. Free medical consultation, laboratory screening and eye Checkup were conducted onsite.

THE HEALTH OUTREACH

The free medical outreach was held daily at Umuhie Town Hall in Ikperejere, Ihitte Uboma from the morning hours till 5pm.

A briefing of the medical team was done before the outreach commenced. The CEO through the head of the medical team emphasized the need for collaborative effort and team work among the health professionals.

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REPORTS & RECOMMENDATION



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The outreach was a successful one, as many people with different ailments benefited from it. As one of the optometrists that participated in the program, I attended to lots of people with refractive errors, presbyopia and different eye diseases ranging from Glaucoma (in some cases, Advanced glaucoma), cataract, retinal degeneration, Diabetic and Hypertensive retinopathy etc. Most of these patients when asked, have not been to hospital or clinic to sought for medical care as they cannot afford the bills but with the help of this program, people were treated and properly counselled at no cost. Big thanks to the sponsor.

I recommend that more classes of ophthalmic drugs are included in the drugs so that a wider range of eye problems can be managed in the program, and also for more eye doctors to be incorporated into the program to reduce the rush as almost every patient wants his/her eye to be checked

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I sincerely appreciate the sponsors of joyful health foundation; Dr. Philip Okeke and his amiable wife Nr. Chinonye Okeke for being magnanimous in giving back to their community despite the economy down turn you all are exceptional, may the good lord continue to bless you and your offspring and I pray for God's divine favours, grace, providence and protection upon your household in Jesus name amen.

I was overwhelmed by the warm reception and genuine hospitality of Dr. Philip's household and the gratitude of the community at large whilst the outreach was going on, the aged villagers will always tell me in most of my encounters with them, "**Anwuchula**", meaning I almost died.

In the course of the outreach I observed that some ailments were more prevalent like, scabies cataract, hypertension, Arthritis, fungal infection and cough.

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RECOMMENDATION

My suggestion and contribution for a better outreach next time includes:

- I suggest we buy more cough medications, and Antihistamines.
- I noticed and must commend that there was enough antimalarial medications and antibiotics this year, which means our reports are being considered.
- I suggest we add muscle relaxants, permethrin cream and malathion lotion for scabies, Antifungals like fluconazole tabs and clotrimazole cream.



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OUTREACH REPORT

Patient Care and Findings

During the outreach, patients received comprehensive medical attention. Common illnesses were treated, ranging from flu, malaria, typhoid, and anti-worm medications. Notably, the majority of patients above 40 years presented with eye-related issues, including: Glaucoma, Cataracts, and Degenerative eye diseases: Conditions such as pterygium and pinguecula were common, underscoring the need for preventive measures and proper eye care.

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I wish to express my profound gratitude to the founder of Joyful Health Foundation, Dr. Philip Okeke, and his amiable wife, Nurse Chinenye Okeke, for the resources invested in this foundation and for the opportunity given to me to be part of this great initiative.

Impact of the Outreach

Beyond physical health, the outreach also provided an opportunity to focus on the psychological health needs of patients. I encountered individuals who, despite being physically healthy, were struggling with mental health challenges due to issues like the loss of loved ones.

I commend the foundation for facilitating diagnostic tests such as malaria, typhoid, HIV, syphilis, blood sugar levels, and Hepatitis B. These tests were conducted based on the signs and symptoms presented by each patient. Additionally, the outreach enabled me to provide health education to many patients, further enhancing their understanding of personal health management.

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Observations During the Outreach

1. Noise Pollution: The environment on the first and second days of the outreach was noisy, which affected the medical team's ability to discharge their duties effectively.
2. Common Health Issues:
 - Many patients presented with malaria.
 - A significant number of elderly individuals had poorly managed diabetes and hypertension.
3. Hesitation Among Youths: Many young adults were reluctant to undergo tests such as HIV and Hepatitis B due to fear, particularly after engaging in unprotected sex.
4. High Demand for Eye Screening: Almost all patients expressed a desire for eye screening, creating a heavy workload for the few available optometrists.

Recommendations

- Noise Control: Implement strict measures to reduce noise pollution during medical outreach activities.
- Health Education: Sensitize community members on the prevention of malaria, diabetes, and hypertension, particularly for the elderly.
- Awareness Campaigns: Create awareness about infectious diseases like HIV and Hepatitis B, targeting younger individuals.
- Increase Optometry Workforce: Employ more optometrists to handle the high demand for eye screening.
- Adequate Counseling: Provide proper counseling for individuals diagnosed with infectious diseases to help them cope and manage their conditions effectively.

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